

FOR YOUR FIRST DAY AND BEYOND

New Job Confidence Kit

Day One · Week One · 90 Days

A calm, structured way to navigate a new job —
without losing yourself in the overwhelm.

FORM & FERN

Before Day One: Prep Checklist

A calm start begins the night before. Get the logistics handled so day one is one less thing to worry about.

- ☐ Confirmed start time, location (or login details), and dress code
- ☐ Laid out or packed what you're wearing the next morning
- ☐ Test-ran the commute or logged in early to check remote access
- ☐ Gathered ID, bank details, and any paperwork HR asked for
- ☐ Charged your phone and laptop, and packed a charger
- ☐ Wrote down your new manager's name and how to reach them
- ☐ Prepped one or two questions you want to ask on day one
- ☐ Planned a simple, ready-to-go breakfast and lunch
- ☐ Set an alarm with extra buffer time — arriving early beats rushing

Day One Survival Checklist

You don't need to have it all figured out today — just get through it, one step at a time.

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- ☐ Brought a notebook or this kit to jot down names and instructions
 - ☐ Practiced a short, simple way to introduce yourself
 - ☐ Asked where the bathroom, kitchen, and exits are — no shame in asking
 - ☐ Wrote down every name you heard, even if you'll double check later
 - ☐ Asked what to do at lunchtime instead of guessing
 - ☐ Gave yourself permission to say "I'm not sure yet, I'll find out"
 - ☐ Noted one thing that felt reassuring or went smoothly today
 - ☐ Noted one question to ask tomorrow instead of stressing tonight
 - ☐ Did one small thing for yourself after work, regardless of how it went

People & Names Tracker

You'll meet a lot of people fast. A quick note beats trying to remember it all in your head.

- ☐ Logged their name, role, and team for everyone you met today
- ☐ Noted one memorable detail to help the name stick
- ☐ Marked who your day-to-day go-to person seems to be
- ☐ Marked who to ask about IT, HR, and building/office logistics
- ☐ Noted who seemed friendly and easy to ask a follow-up question
- ☐ Noted anyone you specifically want to reconnect with this week
- ☐ Flagged names you're still unsure how to pronounce, to check quietly
- ☐ Reviewed your list at the end of each day while it's still fresh
- ☐ Set a reminder to review the whole list again at the end of week one

Culture & Unwritten Rules Log

Every workplace has norms nobody writes down. Notice them instead of guessing.

- ☐ Noted how people actually communicate — chat, email, in person
- ☐ Noted the real meeting norms — on time, cameras on, how casual
- ☐ Noted the actual dress code, not just what the handbook says
- ☐ Noted how decisions seem to get made and who's usually in the room
- ☐ Noted what "urgent" seems to mean here in practice
- ☐ Noted how people handle being unsure — do they ask, or dig in alone
- ☐ Noted anything that surprised you compared to your last workplace
- ☐ Noted one unwritten rule you picked up on just by observing
- ☐ Circled anything worth asking a trusted coworker to confirm

First Week: A Reflection

A short space to process this transition — it's a big one, even when it's a good change.

- ☐ What surprised you most about the role or the team so far?
- ☐ What was harder than you expected this week?
- ☐ What went better than you expected?
- ☐ What's one small win worth celebrating from this week?
- ☐ What's one thing you'd do differently if the week started over?
- ☐ How are you feeling about this change, honestly?
- ☐ What questions are you still sitting with after week one?
- ☐ What's one thing you're already glad about with this move?
- ☐ What's one thing you want to remember about this exact moment?

30-Day Check-In: Wins & Adjustments

The new-job fog usually starts lifting around now. Take stock of where things stand.

- ☐ Listed 3 things you've learned that felt confusing at first
- ☐ Listed one win you're proud of from the first month
- ☐ Noted a task or process you're still finding your footing with
- ☐ Noted whether your workload feels realistic or needs a conversation
- ☐ Identified one relationship at work you want to build further
- ☐ Noted whether you've settled into a basic daily rhythm yet
- ☐ Wrote down one thing to bring up at your next check-in with your manager
- ☐ Noted how your energy levels have been most days
- ☐ Gave yourself credit for making it through the first month

60-Day Check-In: Building Your Routine

Less scrambling, more rhythm. Start layering in the habits that make the job sustainable.

- ☐ Set a consistent start-of-day routine that works for this role
- ☐ Identified your most productive hours and protected them where you can
- ☐ Built a simple system for tracking tasks so nothing slips
- ☐ Noted which meetings are genuinely useful vs. optional for you
- ☐ Started saying no (politely) to requests outside your role, when needed
- ☐ Checked in with yourself on work-life balance so far
- ☐ Identified one skill you want to strengthen over the next month
- ☐ Noted one process you could suggest improving, when the time feels right
- ☐ Reviewed your 30-day notes to see how far you've already come

90-Day Check-In: Progress Without Comparison

This is where it starts to feel like your job, not just a new one. Comparison to tenured coworkers isn't a fair yardstick.

- ☐ Noted something you now do without thinking that once felt hard
- ☐ Noted a moment someone relied on your knowledge or judgment
- ☐ Reviewed whether the role matches what you expected going in
- ☐ Identified a goal for the next 90 days, not just the last 90
- ☐ Noted a relationship at work that's become genuinely comfortable
- ☐ Reminder: everyone's ramp-up timeline looks different — yours is valid
- ☐ Reminder: asking questions at 90 days is still completely normal
- ☐ Noted one thing you'd tell a friend starting a new job tomorrow
- ☐ Gave yourself real credit for the effort these 90 days have taken

Manager 1:1 Prep Sheet

Use this before any check-in with your manager so you walk in with something to say, not just to listen.

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- ☐ Listed 1-2 wins or progress points to mention this check-in
 - ☐ Listed 1-2 things you're currently stuck on or unsure about
 - ☐ Noted any workload or priority question you want clarity on
 - ☐ Noted any resource, access, or support you still need
 - ☐ Prepared one question about how your manager prefers to communicate
 - ☐ Prepared one question about what success looks like in this role
 - ☐ Left space to jot down what your manager says during the check-in
 - ☐ Noted any follow-up items to complete before the next check-in
 - ☐ Reviewed last check-in's notes before walking into this one
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Questions Worth Asking

Organize your questions here so you don't have to hold them all in your head — bring this to onboarding sessions or 1:1s.

- ☐ What does success look like in this role at 30, 60, and 90 days?
- ☐ Who are the key people I should build a relationship with early on?
- ☐ What tools, systems, or docs should I get familiar with first?
- ☐ How does this team prefer to give and receive feedback?
- ☐ What's the best way to reach you if something urgent comes up?
- ☐ Are there any team traditions or norms I should know about?
- ☐ What's a common mistake new hires make here that I can avoid?
- ☐ What resources exist if I want to grow or upskill in this role?
- ☐ Who can I ask if I have a question you're not the right person for?

Boundaries & Energy Management

New-job fatigue is real. This page is about organizing your own limits, not professional or medical advice.

- ☐ Set a rough end-of-day cutoff for checking messages
- ☐ Identified one thing outside work that recharges you and scheduled it
- ☐ Noted your realistic weekly capacity vs. what's being asked of you
- ☐ Practiced one polite way to say "let me check and get back to you"
- ☐ Noted any early sign of overwhelm worth paying attention to
- ☐ Identified one person you can be honest with if things feel like too much
- ☐ Set a reminder to actually take your lunch break, not skip it
- ☐ Reviewed whether your commute/schedule is sustainable long-term
- ☐ Reminder: settling in takes real time — pace yourself accordingly

Key Contacts & Logistics Sheet

Fill this out during week one and keep it somewhere easy to find.

- ☐ HR contact name, email, and phone extension
- ☐ IT helpdesk contact and how to submit a request
- ☐ Direct manager's name, email, and preferred contact method
- ☐ Benefits enrollment deadline and where to complete it
- ☐ Building/office access: badge, parking, or entry instructions
- ☐ Payroll contact or portal for pay and timesheet questions
- ☐ Team distribution list or main chat group name
- ☐ Emergency contact procedure if you're sick or running late
- ☐ Login portal links for key systems you'll use regularly